

support.” Also, in 3D Mark Pro, it gives a Direct3D error with a ‘pixel shader’ problem. How can I play the game?

Avik

A Your graphics card does not support pixel shader—a graphics function that calculates effects on a per-pixel basis, giving ambience and a look of realism to the displayed image. You would need to upgrade it to at least a GeForce4 Ti card. If you are upgrading, go for a higher-end card, say the GeForce FX5950. If you are looking for a slightly cheaper card, try the GeForce FX 5200 or the FX 5700, or the 9600 Series from ATI.

Q I have a Compaq Presario 3600m machine with a Pentium 4, 1.5 GHz processor, 128 MB of SDRAM, and an nVidia Vanta graphics card with 16 MB of memory. My problem is, of late, no games seem to work on my PC.

The error messages mainly show that my hardware does not support my games. *Max Payne 2* was the last game that worked fine. After that, whether it is *NFS Underground*, *Doom* or *FIFA 2005*, it does not work. Will I have to buy a new computer, a new processor, or a new graphics card?

Anjan Jyoti Bora

A The problem lies mainly with your RAM and your graphics card. You have not mentioned which motherboard you are using, but we think it will not support DDR RAM. The best solution would be to go for a complete overhaul of your system, wherein you upgrade to a Pentium 4 2.4 or 2.8 with at least 256 MB of DDR 400 RAM, and a decent 64 MB graphics card, say a GeForce 5700 Ultra. That should let you play all the latest games at fairly decent settings. For a full comparison and specification, check out the graphics cards shootout in the January 2005 issue of Digit. If you do not want to go in for a complete overhaul, you could go in for a GeForce4 Ti card, which should let you play quite a few of these games at the minimum settings. Make sure to check what AGP slot your motherboard supports—8x or 4x. 8x is backward com-